3.2.6 Reaction with ninhydrin

Ninhydrin oxidatively decarboxylates an amino acid to CO_2 and an aldehyde. The reduced ninhydrin subsequently reacts with another molecule of ninhydrin to form a purple complex which absorbs light at 570 nm

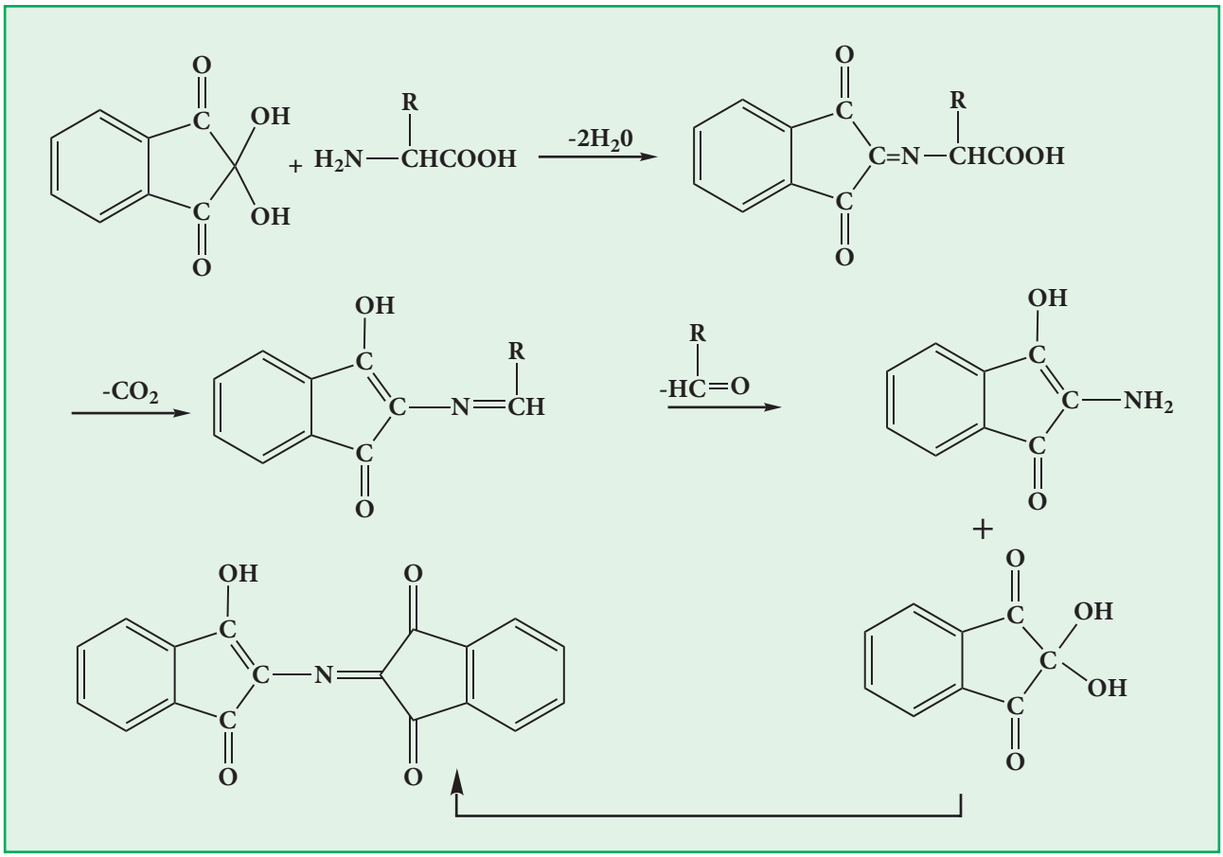


Figure 3.6 Reaction with ninhydrin

3.2.7 Essential amino acids

Certain amino acids cannot be synthesised by our body. Such amino acids must be compulsorily included in our diet for a healthy life. Such amino acids are called essential amino acids. For humans 10 amino acids are essential, that includes arginine, methionine, histidine, phenylalanine, valine,leucine, isoleucine, lysine, threonine and tryptophan (MATT VILL PHLY).

3.3 Proteins and their structure

Proteins are made up of the 20 different amino acids. These amino acids are joined together by a covalent linkage commonly known as a peptide bond. The linear sequence of these linked amino acids is specific for a protein. The amino acid sequence contains necessary information for that protein to fold into a unique three dimensional structure

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